



Blueprint for a better future, on and off the field

While the first edition of WPL needed to be thrust up by performances from proven international pros, season two saw the **Indian talent pool** come to the fore.

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A shattered sponsor car window, a team captain tackling a pitch invader, sprinklers turning on during a tense finish, and a title triumph for the Royal Challengers Bangalore — it's safe to say that most of these things were not expected in the Women's Premier League (WPL) this season. From unusual moments like those mentioned above to a final week that featured incredible turnarounds and outstanding performances from special players facing tough challenges, the league's second chapter provided plenty of entertainment.

One does not get to see a captain of Meg Lanning's stature cry every day. There were eerie similarities to last

season's summit clash. Delhi Capitals won the toss, batted first, collapsed, and then took the defence to the last over before the low total came back to bite it. After a hellish loop of three hours where she fought tooth and nail to find victory in a hopeless place, Lanning and her side came up short.

Glassy eyed at first, consolation from teammates opened the floodgates as she remained rooted to the dugout, a towel covering her face as the tears rolled down. These tears were shed in a country she has tormented internationally for a decade, en route to five World Cup